



106 years ROSAKUTTY

Homemaker, Edamakudi, Kerala

She saw her grandchildren using computers and developed a craving to beat them at it. When she first walked in to enroll herself, the teachers fell off their chairs at the state-sponsored e-literacy camp in her village. But within days, she took to the mouse and keyboard like a fish to water. Rosakutty is India's only—and perhaps the world's oldest—computer student. And her indomitable spirit is the key to her long life, say gerontologists. For, unlike most centenarians Rosakutty doesn't have enormously healthy habits. She doesn't thrive on greens and

fruits. For her, no meal is complete unless there's some spicy fish, chicken, lamb or beef curry with it. What's more, she's hooked on snuff and smokes the occasional *beedi*. Yet she has no illnesses, bathes herself, walks few miles a day without effort and does small chores in the kitchen efficiently.

She was born in 1892 in Kerala, the year top-grade cricket kicked off in India and *Adventures of Sherlock Holmes* hit the stands in Britain. All the rest are little more than footnotes in history, but Rosakutty is very much a part of the present. In white *chatta-mundu* and huge gold earrings, she may look like a typical granny. But one knows better.

by Ashok K. Damodaran

102 years PARVATI AMMAL

Homemaker, Chennai

Vitamin C is probably the life-enhancer for her. She gorged on mangoes all her life. That and the long walks she took daily in her youth. No wonder, she bounced back from a major hip surgery in record time this year and started walking—a medical miracle.

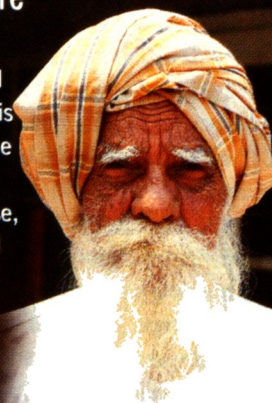


M. K. RAJASHEKAR

115 years KARTAR SINGH

Farmer, Ludhiana

He was born on a farm in Ludhiana. He resides there and leads an active life, still working in the farm and feeding his cattle twice a day. His outlook on life is as rugged as the view from his home. His tips on longevity? "That's easy—exercise, working in the fields and no bad habits."



RAJESH BHAMRA